



suitable for Indian bodies. The one and only Kapil Dev hardly ever went to the gym, yet he bowled hundreds of deliveries in the nets and ran several laps of the ground after net sessions. Apart from a hamstring injury that ended his long career, he had no other injuries despite bowling heaps of overs every day on lifeless surfaces in India. The body science experts at the IPL, who do not want bowlers to bowl more than 20 deliveries in the nets, would have been horrified if they had seen Kapil bowl hundreds of deliveries. The proof of the pudding is in the eating, as the old saying goes, and when you compare the career of Kapil with those of India's current fast bowlers — who bowl only 20-odd deliveries in the nets — it tells you that body science is an individual matter and that every player needs to be treated according to their own strength and endurance.

The recent news that the ECB is going to retire the Pataudi Trophy, given to the winners of the Test series between England and India in England, is disturbing indeed. This is the first time one has heard of a trophy named after

Bumpy road: Travis Head has made a few blistering starts this season but hasn't turned them into the dominant innings he regularly produced last year. K.R. DEEPAK

individual players being retired, though the decision is entirely the ECB's, and the BCCI may well have been informed. It shows a total lack of sensitivity to the contribution made by the Pataudis to cricket in both England and India. There may well be a new trophy named after more recent players, and here's hoping that if an Indian player has been approached, he will have the good sense to politely decline — not only out of respect for two former India captains but also to avoid the same fate of having a trophy named after him retired after he is gone. The ECB is fully entitled to name the trophy after one of their own players, but I, along with loads of Indian cricket supporters, fervently hope that any other Indian cricketer will have the smarts to decline, lest history repeats itself as it has with the Pataudi Trophy.



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